

OPERATIONAL MANUAL FOR FIELD INSPECTION TEAMS
STANDARD IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

Procedures for Verification of Packaged Goods & Statutory Audit

1. OBJECTIVE & SCOPE

These guidelines provide standardized field procedures for Legal Metrology Officers (LMOs) across States and Union Territories for verifying pre-packaged commodities, auditing retail declarations, detecting fraud, and issuing statutory notices under the Legal Metrology Act, 2009.

2. PRINCIPAL DISPLAY PANEL (PDP) VERIFICATION PROTOCOL

The Principal Display Panel area must be computed in accordance with Rule 7:

- **Rectangular packages:** Area = Height × Width of the largest display face.
- **Cylindrical / Bottle packages:** Area = 40% of (Height × Circumference).
- **Other shapes:** Area = 20% of total surface area of package.

3. MAXIMUM PERMISSIBLE ERROR (MPE) ON NET QUANTITY

Under the First Schedule, commodities packed by weight/volume are subject to statutory error tolerances:

Declared Quantity (g or ml)	Maximum Permissible Error (MPE) as % or g/ml
Up to 50 g / ml	9% of declared quantity
50 to 100 g / ml	4.5 g or ml
100 to 200 g / ml	4.5% of declared quantity
200 to 300 g / ml	9 g or ml
300 to 500 g / ml	3% of declared quantity
500 to 1000 g / ml (1 kg/l)	15 g or ml
Above 1000 g / ml	1.5% of declared quantity

4. PROTOCOL FOR DETECTING DUAL MRP

Inspectors must conduct macro visual audits of price regions. If a paper sticker or label is affixed over a printed price, officers must peel back the edge to inspect whether the underlying print carries a lower MRP. Any multiple price representation constitutes an immediate ground for seizure under Section 15.

5. AI DIGITAL EVIDENCE CHAIN OF CUSTODY

Photos captured via the PAKSHYA mobile scanner must be cryptographically hashed (SHA-256) at the point of capture to ensure tamper-proof admissible legal evidence before the Adjudicating Officer.